A. O'Brien

Unbound for Utah!

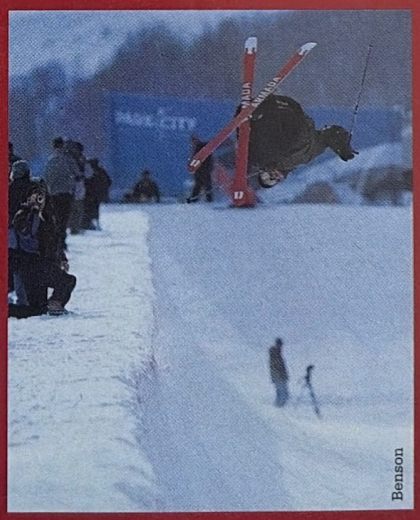
Tanner and Pep are off to Park City.

For the past three years, Mammoth's legendary Unbound Terrain Park has been synonymous with perfect kickers, creative jibs, and two franchise skiers: Tanner Hall and Pep Fujas. The two helped establish freeskiing in a park long regarded as the center of the snowboarding universe and were partially responsible for Unbound being named the best park in North America in *FREEZE*'s 2003 park review. Also ranked in this review was Park City … as the disappointing twenty-fourth-place finisher. So why the hell are T. Hall and Mr. Fujas packing their bags for Utah?

"Park City is getting bigger and bigger," explains Tanner from the local condo he recently purchased from his parents. "The park is getting sick."

Mark those words: Park City is stepping it up. The resort is dead set on transforming its park into a serious contender, and it plans to use Tanner and Pep as a resource. A slew of new features including a 40-foot down-flat-down box and a 50-foot urban decline rail are already in the works, and there have even been discussions of the two skiers designing their own signature rails. "We have a lot of progressive ideas we'd like to make happen," says Jim Mengan, Park City's new action-sports marketing director, whose terrain-park designs have won praise industry-wide. "Definitely expect some changes."

Mere terrain parks can't contain skiers of this caliber, of course, and the resort's draw is only part of the equation. Most of the insane photography and film you see of Tanner and Pep is produced deep in the backcountry—something of which Utah has a few acres. "Park City might be a step up from Mammoth," says Pep, "just because of all the great backcountry. Mammoth doesn't have much, and the good stuff that's accessible is really getting blown out." The famed superkickers of Grizzly Gulch and the endless snowmobile access of the Wasatch backcountry will provide the duo with more photo-shoot options than they could pillage in a lifetime.



Benson

Sweeten the deal with nearby Salt Lake City's reputation as a rail mecca, and an airport that's 30 minutes away (Reno/Tahoe International is three hours from Mammoth), and the decision came easier than you might expect. "There're cool people there, and the park is obviously great, so yeah, I'm going to miss it," Tanner says of Mammoth. "But I just wanted to ride here. You've got Snowbird, Alta, Solitude, Brighton, Grizzly Gulch, The Canyons … plus there're good skateparks and more stuff going on. You've got everything here."—**Jeff Foss**